

2026 - Group 1 Preliminary Exam - Geography of India

Answer Key | Q3-Q155, 11 questions

Q.No	Question	Correct Answer	Syllabus	Explanation
3	Match the following : (a) 1737 (b) 1970 (c) 1991 (d) 1999 1. Orissa cyclone 2. Calcutta cyclone 3. Bhola cyclone 4. Bangladesh cyclone (A) (a) 2 (b) 3 (c) 4 (d) 1 (B) (a) 3 (b) 4 (c) 2 (d) 1 (C) (a) 4 (b) 3 (c) 2 (d) 1 (D) (a) 1 (b) 2 (c) 3 (d) 4	A) (a) 2 (b) 3 (c) 4 (d) 1 [1737-Calcutta cyclone, 1970-Bhola cyclone, 1991-Bangladesh cyclone, 1999-Orissa cyclone]	Unit II - Geography of India	These are among the deadliest tropical cyclones of the Bay of Bengal. The 1737 Calcutta cyclone struck the Hooghly delta and is one of the earliest well-documented catastrophic cyclones, killing an estimated 300,000 people. The 1970 Bhola cyclone hit East Pakistan (now Bangladesh) and remains the deadliest tropical cyclone ever recorded, killing 300,000-500,000 people, and is cited as a catalyst for the Bangladesh Liberation War. The 1991 Bangladesh cyclone, a category-5 storm, killed roughly 138,000 people around Chittagong. The 1999 Odisha (Orissa) super cyclone was the strongest storm to hit the Indian coast in the 20th century, killing about 10,000 people, and directly led to the setting up of the Odisha State Disaster Management Authority. Hence the match is 1737-Calcutta, 1970-Bhola, 1991-Bangladesh, 1999-Orissa, option (A). Source: Class 9 Geography, Unit 3 "Atmosphere"
4	Which of the following are examples of nature-based solutions for disaster risk reduction mentioned in the Tamilnadu State Disaster Management (TNSDM) Policy? (i) Wetland Restoration (ii) Blue - Green infrastructure (iii) Concrete flood wall construction (iv) Sponge cities (A) (ii) and (iii) only (B) (i), (ii) and (iv) only	B) (i), (ii) and (iv) only	Unit II - Geography of India	Nature-based solutions (NbS) for disaster risk reduction rely on restoring or mimicking natural ecosystems to absorb hazards like floods, rather than relying purely on hard/"grey" engineering. Wetland restoration recreates natural flood buffers that absorb excess rainwater; blue-green infrastructure combines water bodies (blue) with vegetated spaces (green), such as rain gardens and urban ponds, to manage stormwater naturally; sponge cities is an urban-planning concept using permeable surfaces, parks and wetlands to let cities "soak up" and slowly release rainwater. Concrete flood wall construction, in contrast, is a conventional hard-engineering solution, not

	(C) (i) and (iv) only (D) (i), (ii) and (iii) only			a nature-based one. Tamil Nadu's State Disaster Management Policy promotes such nature-based approaches, so the correct set is (i), (ii) and (iv) only, option (B).
34	Match correctly the following tourist spots with their corresponding locations : (a) Adavinainar Dam (b) Ramanadhi Dam (c) Agasthiar falls (d) Pulianchola 1. Kadayam village 2. Kolli hills 3. Mekkarai village 4. Papanasam (A) (a)-3 (b)-4 (c)-1 (d)-2 (B) (a)-3 (b)-2 (c)-1 (d)-4 (C) (a)-3 (b)-1 (c)-2 (d)-4 (D) (a)-3 (b)-1 (c)-4 (d)-2	D) (a)-3 (b)-1 (c)-4 (d)-2	Unit II - Geography of India	Agasthiar (Agasthiyar) Falls lies at Papanasam in the Western Ghats of Tirunelveli/Tenkasi district - Papanasam is in fact the name commonly used for this very falls/dam site on the Thamirabarani river, so (c) pairs with 4. Ramanadhi Dam, also in the Tenkasi/Tirunelveli hill region, is situated near Kadayam village, giving (b)-1. Pulianchola is a well-known waterfall picnic spot located in the Kolli Hills of Namakkal district, so (d) pairs with 2. That leaves Adavinainar Dam matched with Mekkarai village (3), a hill-foot dam site in the same Western Ghats belt - giving the full correct sequence 3,1,4,2. Source: Class 10 Geography, Unit 6 "Physical Geography of Tamil Nadu"
53	One of the following is true about the Reservoirs and Source river. (i) Tehri on the River Bhagirathi. (ii) Rajghat on the Betwa. (iii) Dudhganga on the Godavari. (A) (i) only (B) (i) and (iii) only (C) (i) and (ii) only (D) (ii) only	C) (i) and (ii) only	Unit II - Geography of India	The Tehri Dam, one of India's tallest dams, is built on the Bhagirathi River (a headstream of the Ganga) in Uttarakhand, so statement (i) is correct. The Rajghat Dam is constructed on the Betwa River (a Yamuna tributary) on the Uttar Pradesh-Madhya Pradesh border, so statement (ii) is also correct. However, the Dudhganga Dam is located in Kolhapur district of Maharashtra on the Dudhganga River, which is a tributary of the Krishna river system, not the Godavari - so statement (iii) is incorrect. Hence only (i) and (ii) are true, making (C) the answer. Source: Class 10 Social Science, Geography Unit 3 "India - Agriculture"
54	Which of the following infrastructure components are included in the Zojila	B) (1), (2) and (3) only	Unit II - Geography of India	The Zojila Tunnel, under construction on the Srinagar-Kargil-Leh national highway across the Zojila Pass in the Himalayas, is designed as a single-tube, bi-directional,

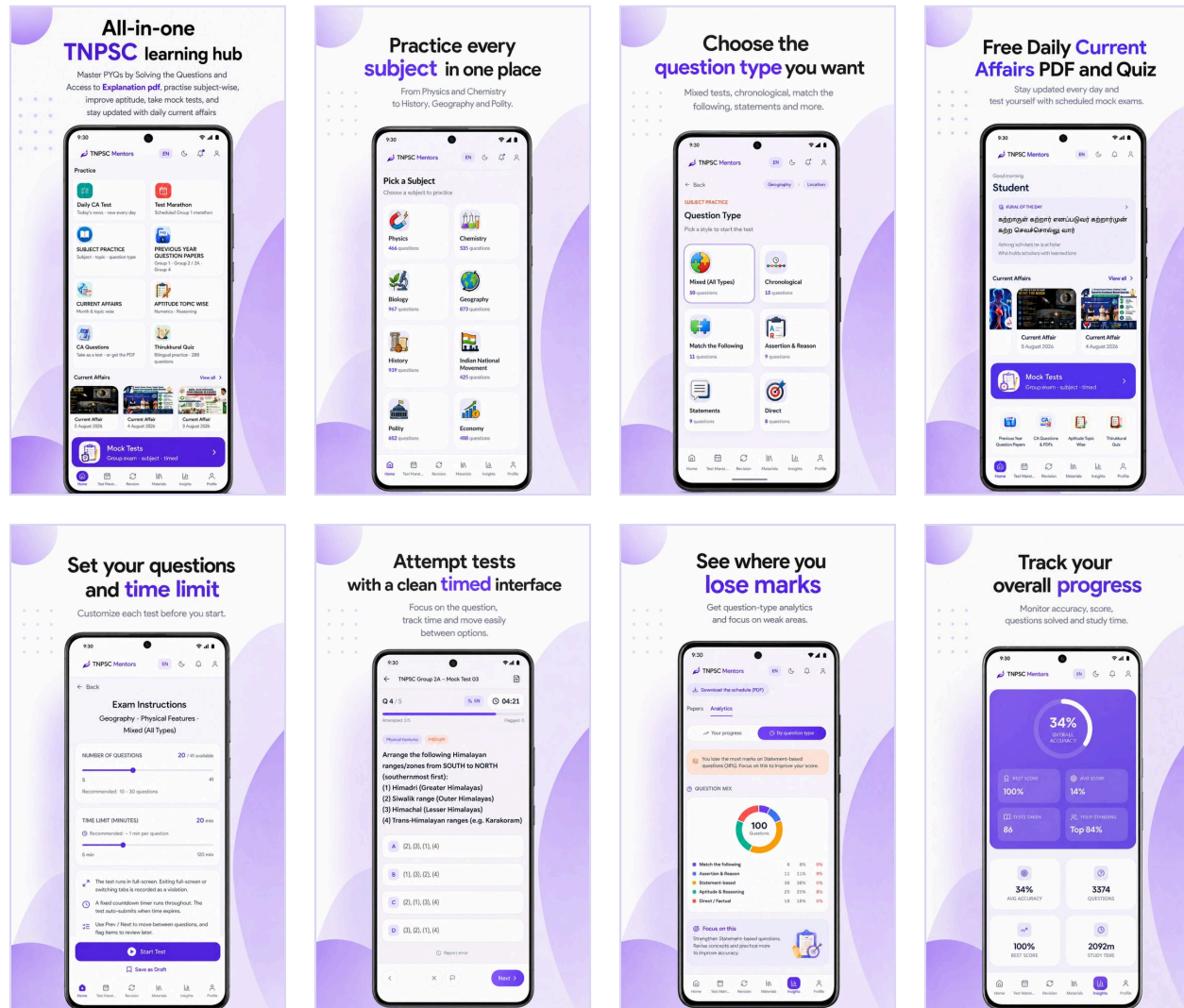
	Tunnel Project? (1) Snow galleries (2) Avalanche protection structures (3) Bi-directional horse shoe passage (4) Inland waterways (A) (2) and (4) only (B) (1), (2) and (3) only (C) (1) and (4) only (D) (1), (2) and (4) only			horseshoe-shaped tunnel (component 3) to provide all-weather connectivity to Ladakh. Because the pass is extremely prone to heavy snowfall and avalanches, the project also includes snow galleries (component 1) to shield the approach roads from snow accumulation and dedicated avalanche protection structures (component 2). Inland waterways (component 4) have nothing to do with a mountain road tunnel, so the correct set is (1), (2) and (3) only, i.e., option (B).
75	Arrange chronological order of dam construction in Tamil Nadu (1) Mullai Periyar dam (2) Mettur dam (3) Vaigai dam (4) Bhavani Sagar dam (A) (1), (4), (2), (3) (B) (1), (2), (4), (3) (C) (2), (4), (3), (1) (D) (4), (3), (2), (1)	B) (1), (2), (4), (3)	Unit II - Geography of India	Mullai Periyar Dam across the Periyar river was completed in 1895, making it the earliest of the four. Mettur Dam on the Cauvery was completed in 1934, followed by Bhavanisagar Dam on the Bhavani river which was completed in the late 1940s-1955 period, and finally the Vaigai Dam near Madurai, completed in 1959. This gives the chronological sequence Mullai Periyar (1) - Mettur (2) - Bhavani Sagar (4) - Vaigai (3), corresponding to option (B). Source: Class 10 Social Science, Geography Unit 7 "Human Geography of Tamil Nadu"
101	Consider the statements given below and choose the correct answer : Assertion [A] : Iron ore is the most widely distributed element of the earth's crust and it rarely occurs in a free state. Reason [R] : Magnetite is black in colour and has 60% of pure iron. (A) Both [A] and [R] are true ; [R] explains [A] (B) Both [A] and [R] are true ; [R] does not explain [A] (C) [A] is true, [R] is false (D) [A] is false, [R] is true	B) Both [A] and [R] are true ; [R] does not explain [A]	Unit II - Geography of India	Iron ore is indeed one of the most abundantly and widely distributed metallic minerals in the earth's crust, and because iron is highly reactive it almost never occurs as a free (native) metal, instead combining with oxygen to form ores such as haematite and magnetite - so Assertion [A] is true. Magnetite (Fe₃O₄) is a black-coloured, strongly magnetic iron ore that typically contains about 60-72% pure iron, the highest iron content among natural ores, so Reason [R] is also a true statement on its own. However, [R] only describes magnetite's colour and iron percentage; it says nothing about why iron is widely distributed or why it rarely occurs free, so [R] does not actually explain [A]. Both statements are independently correct facts about iron ore geology but are not causally linked, giving option (B).

				Source: Class 10 Social Science, Geography Unit 4 "India - Resources and Industries"
102	Assertion [A] : Tamil Nadu state remains dry during the South West Monsoon season. Reason [R] : Tamil Nadu coast lies in the rain shadow area of the Arabian sea, current and is parallel to the Bay of Bengal current. (A) [A] is true but [R] is false (B) Both [A] and [R] are true and [R] is the correct explanation of [A] (C) [A] is false, [R] is true (D) Both [A] and [R] are true and [R] is not the correct explanation of [A]	B) Both [A] and [R] are true and [R] is the correct explanation of [A]	Unit II - Geography of India	During the South West Monsoon (June-September), moisture-laden winds from the Arabian Sea strike the Western Ghats first, dropping most of their rain on the windward (Kerala) side, so Tamil Nadu, lying on the leeward or 'rain shadow' side of the Ghats, receives very little rainfall and stays comparatively dry - Assertion [A] is true. The Tamil Nadu coastline also runs roughly parallel to the direction of the Bay of Bengal branch of the monsoon current, so those winds blow along the coast rather than striking it perpendicularly, further reducing orographic rainfall - Reason [R] is true and is exactly why [A] happens. This is why Tamil Nadu instead depends heavily on the North East (retreating) Monsoon for its main rains. Source: Class 10 Social Science, Geography Unit 6 "Physical Geography of Tamil Nadu" and Class 10 Social Science, Geography Unit 2 "Climate and Natural Vegetation of India"
153	According to the 2011 census, which district in Tamilnadu records the lowest literacy rate? (A) Dharmapuri (B) Namakkal (C) Ariyalur (D) Krishnagiri	A) Dharmapuri	Unit II - Geography of India	As per the 2011 Census, Tamil Nadu's overall literacy rate was about 80.1%, but there was wide variation among districts, with the hilly, largely agrarian northern districts lagging behind the more urbanised and industrialised ones. Dharmapuri recorded the lowest district literacy rate in the state (around 73-74%), reflecting historically weaker access to schooling infrastructure in that region, while Kanyakumari topped the list with the state's highest literacy rate. Namakkal, Ariyalur and Krishnagiri also had literacy rates below the state average but were not the lowest. Hence option (A) is correct. Source: Class 10 Social Science, Geography Unit 7 "Human Geography of Tamil Nadu"
154	Buckingham canal connects the	B) Andhra Pradesh	Unit II - Geography of India	The Buckingham Canal is a navigable, brackish-water canal running roughly parallel to the Coromandel (Bay of

	following two states. (A) Telungana and Tamil Nadu (B) Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu (C) Odisha and Andhra Pradesh (D) Odisha and Telungana	and Tamil Nadu		Bengal) coast, originally built in stages during the 19th century for inland cargo transport, and later named after the Governor of Madras, the Duke of Buckingham, who extended it. It runs for about 420 km from Kakinada in Andhra Pradesh through Chennai down to Marakkanam in Tamil Nadu, linking a chain of natural backwaters, rivers and deltas along the eastern coast. Since Telangana and Odisha are not on this coastal stretch, only Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu are correctly connected by the canal, making option (B) correct.
155	Assertion [A] : Tamilnadu state climate change knowledge management cell helps in developing climate adaptation strategies and supports decision-making processes. Reason [R] : It provides climate vulnerability assessments climate knowledge portals and sector-wise information on climate change impacts. (A) [A] is true but [R] is false (B) [A] is false but [R] is true (C) Both [A] and [R] are true, and [R] is the correct explanation of [A] (D) Both [A] and [R] are true, but [R] is not the correct explanation of [A]	C) Both [A] and [R] are true, and [R] is the correct explanation of [A]	Unit II - Geography of India	The Tamil Nadu State Climate Change Knowledge Management Cell was set up under the state's climate action framework to consolidate scientific data on climate trends and impacts. It genuinely performs the functions named in the Reason - conducting climate vulnerability assessments, maintaining an online climate-knowledge portal, and compiling sector-wise (agriculture, water, coastal, health) impact information - and it is precisely these functions that enable it to support adaptation-strategy formulation and evidence-based decision-making, which is what the Assertion describes. Since the Reason directly accounts for how the Assertion's outcome is achieved, both statements are true and R correctly explains A, so option (C) is correct.

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